

Our guide pointed to a fist-sized hole in the ground and told us it was a tarantula's home. If the entrance was clean and tidy, the spider was likely still inside; if sealed with silk, it meant the resident had left—or met its end.



In truth, the largest predators pose little danger to humans. The real killers are the ones hidden in the shadows. The rich scent of Brazil nuts attracts not only small forest animals but also the deadly fer-de-lance. With its yellow-and-black pattern, this viper claims the lives of many nut harvesters each year.



The Great Potoo has few predators. Although it is also a nocturnal bird, it is not an owl.